I have come to believe that life is spiritual.

Before anyone starts looking for a pulpit, relax. I still have both feet on the ground. I pay my bills, I understand psychology, and I know that sometimes the reason your life is falling apart is because you have been making terrible decisions. We must be honest with ourselves. 😂

But I also believe there is more to life than what we can explain psychologically.

I believe in God. I believe in Christ. I believe in the things I have been taught about faith. But somewhere along the way, I also began paying attention to the things I could feel, the patterns I kept noticing, and the experiences I struggled to explain.

The energy of people. The atmosphere of certain places. The strange way some interactions leave you feeling unsettled long after the conversation has ended.

Have you ever had someone enter your life and suddenly, mambo ni mengi?

Your peace is gone. Your mind is occupied. Your routine is upside down. You are making decisions that do not even sound like you. Things that were once straightforward have become complicated, and somehow you are spending your evenings analysing conversations like you have been hired by the DCI.

And the funny thing is, the other person might be perfectly fine.

They are sleeping peacefully. Eating well. Posting WhatsApp statuses. Meanwhile, you are here wondering whether you need deliverance, therapy, or a holiday in Diani.

Sometimes, the person is not even deliberately doing anything wrong.

And that is the part I find particularly interesting.

We are comfortable discussing the people who hurt us intentionally. The people who lie, manipulate, betray, or knowingly bring chaos into our lives. Those situations are relatively easy to name. There is an action, there is a consequence, and there is a person who made a choice.

But what do we do with the connections that are difficult to explain?

The ones where nobody has necessarily done anything terrible, yet something about the dynamic seems to leave you worse off than you were before. The ones where you cannot point to a single incident and say, *There. That is where everything changed.* Instead, you look back over a period of time and realise that your life has become strangely unfamiliar to you.

Perhaps you have become more anxious. Perhaps you are distracted in ways you were not before. Maybe you have stopped doing things that used to bring you joy. You are second-guessing yourself, questioning your judgement, or spending an unreasonable amount of time trying to understand a situation that should not require a committee meeting in your head.

And you start wondering what happened.

Was it the person? Was it you? Was it the circumstances surrounding the connection? Or are you simply trying to find a reason for a season of life that would have been difficult regardless of who was standing beside you?

I do not think there is one answer that fits every situation.

But I do think the question deserves more attention than we sometimes give it.

We tend to judge connections by what we can immediately see. Is this person kind? Do we get along? Do we enjoy each other's company? Do they make us laugh? Do we have things in common? These are reasonable questions, of course. Nobody is suggesting that we interrogate potential friends like we are recruiting intelligence officers.

But sometimes, a person can be lovely and still not be a good fit for your life.

You can enjoy someone's company and still find that the dynamic between you is confusing. You can admire someone and still discover that being close to them comes with complications you were not prepared for. You can have genuine affection for a person without the relationship necessarily bringing out the best in either of you.

And perhaps that is one of the more uncomfortable things about being human. We want goodness and compatibility to be the same thing. We want to believe that if someone has a good heart, our connection with them should naturally work.

Unfortunately, life did not consult us before making things complicated.

Two good people can have a difficult dynamic. Two people can care about each other and still repeatedly misunderstand one another. One person's habits, priorities, emotional needs, or way of moving through life can clash with another person's in ways neither of them fully recognises.

Nobody has to be a villain for the situation to become exhausting.

But I also think there are experiences that make us question whether compatibility is the whole story.

Because sometimes, the change feels bigger than the relationship itself.

You meet someone, become involved in their world, and begin noticing changes in other areas of your life. Your focus shifts. Your decisions change. Opportunities you were pursuing lose their place in your mind. You find yourself caught up in situations you would ordinarily have avoided. There seems to be a strange accumulation of things that leave you wondering whether the timing means something.

Now, I know how that sounds.

Tell someone that life was going smoothly before a particular person arrived, and they may immediately ask whether you are blaming that person for your problems. And honestly, that is a fair concern. Humans are very good at noticing patterns, including patterns that may not mean what we think they mean.

When several difficult things happen around the same time, our minds naturally search for a connection. If someone happens to enter our lives during that period, it can become tempting to place them at the centre of the explanation.

But timing alone does not establish cause.

A difficult season can begin before we recognise it. We can make decisions under the influence of excitement, loneliness, attraction, or hope and only notice the consequences much later. Sometimes another person's presence changes our priorities. Sometimes we become so invested in a connection that we neglect other parts of our lives. Sometimes life is simply doing what life does, and we are trying to make the chaos make sense.

I think it is important to admit all of that.

Otherwise, we risk turning every disappointing experience into a spiritual investigation. Before long, somebody has looked at us strangely at the supermarket, our business has had a slow week, and suddenly we are convinced that the entire neighbourhood is conspiring against our destiny.

Please. We still need to check our accounts, examine our decisions, and ask ourselves whether we have been doing what we are supposed to do.

Faith does not excuse us from thinking.

At the same time, I am not entirely comfortable with the idea that anything we cannot explain must therefore be dismissed.

There are things we experience before we have the language to describe them. There are patterns we notice only after living through them several times. There are connections that leave us with questions we cannot neatly resolve, even after we have examined the facts as honestly as we can.

For some people, the language for these experiences is spiritual. They speak about energies, discernment, or a sense that certain connections are not aligned with where they are trying to go in life.

I understand the appeal of that language because it makes room for the possibility that our experience of another person is not limited to a list of their observable qualities.

We do not experience people as lists.

We experience them through conversations, silences, expectations, emotions, choices, timing, and the countless little things that make up being connected to another human being. We experience who we become around them, what we begin to prioritise, and how the relationship fits into the wider shape of our lives.

Whether someone describes that through psychology, spirituality, or simply the complexity of human relationships, I think there is value in paying attention.

What I am less interested in is pretending to know precisely what is happening when I do not.

I cannot confidently say that every person who enters my life and is followed by a difficult season has brought negative energy with them. I cannot say that every unsettling connection is a spiritual warning or that every coincidence has been arranged to communicate something to me.

But I can admit that some experiences have made me more curious about the things I previously took for granted.

Why do certain connections seem to coincide with periods of confusion? Why do some people leave us feeling as though we have lost our footing? Why do we sometimes look back on a particular chapter of our lives and struggle to recognise the person we were while living through it?

And why is it so difficult to accept that we may never have a complete explanation?

Perhaps that is what bothers us most. Not necessarily the experience itself, but the uncertainty surrounding it.

We want to know whether we were supposed to meet that person. We want to know whether the experience was a lesson, a mistake, a coincidence, or something we have not yet understood. We want to know whether we should have recognised something sooner.

We want the story to have a clear meaning because meaning makes pain easier to organise.

If it was a lesson, then at least we learnt something. If it was a warning, then perhaps we can avoid the next one. If the connection was never right for us, then we can stop wondering why we tried so hard to make it work.

But real life does not always provide that kind of closure.

Sometimes you only understand an experience in retrospect. Sometimes you understand parts of it and remain confused about the rest. Sometimes you discover that the person was not the problem in the way you initially thought, but the dynamic between you was still not something you could sustain.

And sometimes, all you can honestly say is that something changed, you did not like what that change was doing to your life, and you needed to understand it better.

I am learning that uncertainty does not automatically make an experience meaningless.

Perhaps I do not need to decide whether something was spiritual, psychological, circumstantial, or some combination of all three before I can reflect on what happened. I can examine my decisions without dismissing my intuition. I can consider spiritual possibilities without treating them as established facts. I can acknowledge that someone affected my life without deciding that they deliberately intended to harm me.

There is a difference between recognising an effect and claiming to know its cause.

That distinction matters to me.

Because if I am honest, I do not want to become someone who suspects people simply because life becomes difficult around them. I do not want to assign spiritual significance to every inconvenience or turn ordinary human complexity into evidence of an invisible battle.

But neither do I want to move through life so determined to appear rational that I ignore my own experiences until they become impossible to overlook.

I want room for both thought and wonder.

I want to be able to ask questions without rushing to conclusions. I want to examine the patterns in my life without assuming that every pattern is a message. I want to remain open to what I do not understand while being honest about what I actually know.

And perhaps most importantly, I want to stop assuming that every meaningful connection is meant to remain in my life.

We place so much emphasis on the significance of meeting someone. We talk about people entering our lives for a reason, about divine timing, about connections that change us. Sometimes we become so fascinated by what a connection might mean that we forget to examine what it is actually doing.

A connection can be significant without being permanent. An experience can teach you something without being something you would choose again. A person can matter to you without being someone with whom you are able to build a peaceful, sustainable relationship.

And none of those things automatically makes either person bad.

Maybe the question is not always whether someone was sent into our lives for a reason. Maybe the more useful question is what we are learning about ourselves through the experience, and whether we are willing to look at that honestly.

Because there is a temptation to focus entirely on the other person. To examine their behaviour, their intentions, their personality, and the possible meaning of their presence until we have very little energy left to examine ourselves.

What did I overlook? What did I welcome into my life without understanding it? What changed in me during that period? Which decisions were mine, regardless of the circumstances? What am I attributing to someone else that I need to take responsibility for myself?

Those questions are not always comfortable. Sometimes they are downright disrespectful to the version of ourselves that would prefer to be an innocent bystander in every unfortunate situation.

But they are necessary.

I can believe that life has a spiritual dimension and still accept that I am responsible for my choices. I can wonder about the energy of a connection without making someone else responsible for everything that goes wrong in my life. I can acknowledge that there are things I do not understand without turning uncertainty into certainty simply because a particular explanation feels convincing.

And I can accept that two people may enter each other's lives with genuine intentions and still discover that something about their connection does not work.

Perhaps that is the revelation I keep returning to.

Not every difficult connection requires a villain, and not every connection that feels significant is necessarily good for us.

Sometimes we meet people whose lives, personalities, circumstances, or ways of relating to us bring out things we were not expecting. Sometimes we change in ways we do not immediately understand. Sometimes we learn something important, and sometimes we simply have an experience that teaches us what we need to pay closer attention to next time.

I do not have to turn every difficult connection into a spiritual warning. I do not have to convince myself that everything happened for a particular reason. And I do not have to dismiss my experience just because I cannot explain every part of it.

I can remain curious.

I can reflect.

I can pray, think, ask questions, and be honest about the things I still do not know.

Because perhaps growing in wisdom is not about becoming so spiritually aware that nothing surprises you anymore. Perhaps it is about becoming humble enough to admit that you will not always understand what is happening while it is happening.

And maybe, just maybe, some people come with weather.

Not necessarily because they are carrying storms inside them, or because they have come to destroy the carefully organised little life you have built for yourself.

Sometimes two worlds meet, and the conditions are simply not what either person expected.

The skies change. Things become complicated. You learn things about yourself that you might not have discovered otherwise.

And eventually, you have to decide what to make of the experience.

Was it incompatibility? Timing? Circumstance? Something spiritual? Something psychological? A little bit of everything?

I may not always know.

But I am beginning to understand that I do not need to solve the entire mystery to recognise that an experience has changed me.

Some people come into your life and bring sunshine. Others seem to arrive just as the skies begin to darken. Some stay long enough for you to understand the season, and others leave you trying to make sense of the forecast long after they are gone.

I am still learning not to confuse the weather with the person.

But I am also learning to pay attention when the skies change.

After all, wisdom is not necessarily knowing who brought the rain.

Sometimes it is learning to recognise that it is raining, asking yourself what the season is teaching you, and deciding how you want to move through it.

And if I ever figure out why certain people seem to arrive with an entire meteorological department attached to them, I will let you know.

For now, I am observing.

Because apparently, life is spiritual, human beings are complicated, and the forecast is not always available on your phone.